

A recent study has found that bees follow a balanced diet. What's your excuse?

The newest study that shows adults need less than 10,000 steps a day to stay on top of their health; the neighbourhood aunty who **insists** her ghar ke nuskhe (home **remedies**) are all one needs. These are all answers to that one question human beings struggle with: How does one stay healthy? One **staple** response that has stood the test of time is a balanced diet. **Turns out**, it is not limited to human beings. **A recent study**, published in Proceedings of the Royal Society B: Biological Sciences, **noted** that **eight species** of wild **bumblebees** “strategically **visit** different flowers to balance their **intake** of protein, fat and carbohydrates”.

The **research**, conducted over eight years in the Colorado Rockies, **shows** that bees do not collect pollen at random. Different pollens carry different **compositions** of **macronutrients** — some are packed with protein, “like a **steak**”, others are more “like a salad”. What enables bees to get the nutrients they need is a “remarkable collective intelligence”. Colonies of bees work together, with the larger-bodied ones consuming pollen high in protein and bees with shorter tongues **seeking** pollen richer in carbohydrates and fats. **A similar study** on elephants’ dietary habits, published in the Royal Society Open Science, **showed** how they, too, have a **varied** diet, informed by nutritional, psychological and social needs.



Today, **spoiled** for choice, with **contradictory** advice coming from a hundred different quarters, the **path** to a healthy life **has** become **needlessly complicated**. Smart watches, smarter diets, and an endless scroll in search for the smartest solution have left human beings more confused than ever before. But the answer could be rather simple: A balanced diet, rest and exercise. Oh, and one piece of advice: When in doubt, follow the bees. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where ‘red’ denotes ‘subject’ and ‘blue’ denotes ‘verb’.

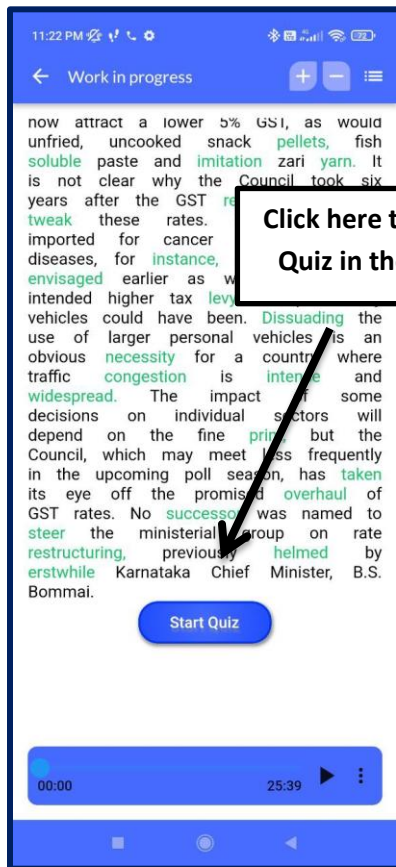
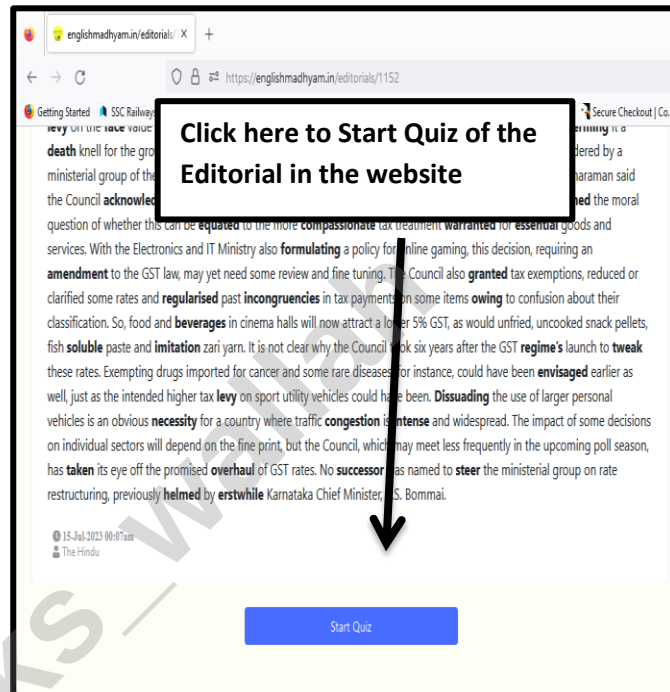
Vocabulary

1. **Balanced diet** (noun) – a diet consisting of a variety of different types of food and providing adequate amounts of the nutrients necessary for good health.
संतुलित आहार
2. **Insist** (verb) – assert, maintain, demand, press, urge आग्रह करना
3. **Remedy** (noun) – cure, treatment, solution, fix, nostrum घरेलू नुस्खा
4. **Staple** (adjective) – main or important, especially in terms of consumption. मुख्य
5. **Turn out** (phrasal verb) – prove, transpire, emerge, end up, result पता चलना
6. **Bumblebee** (noun) – wild bee, Bombus, pollinator, fuzzy bee, bee species भौंरा
7. **Intake** (noun) – consumption, ingestion, uptake, quota, allowance सेवन
8. **Composition** (noun) – makeup, constitution, blend, mix, formulation संरचना
9. **Macronutrient** (noun) – a type of food (e.g. fat, protein, carbohydrate) required in large amounts in the diet.
10. **Steak** (noun) – meat cut, fillet, sirloin, beef slice, chop मांस का टुकड़ा
11. **Seek** (verb) – look for, search for, pursue, go after, aim for तलाश करना
12. **Varied** (adjective) – diverse, assorted, mixed, multifarious, wide-ranging विविध
13. **Spoil** (verb) – ruin, mar, impair, mess up, overindulge बिगाड़ना
14. **Contradictory** (adjective) – conflicting, inconsistent, clashing, opposing, at-odds परस्पर-विरोधी
15. **Needlessly** (adverb) – unnecessarily, gratuitously, superfluously, unduly, without cause अनावश्यक रूप से
16. **Complicated** (adjective) – complex, intricate, involved, convoluted, knotty जटिल

Summary of the Editorial

1. Health advice comes from many sources—studies, gadgets, and traditional remedies—often leaving people confused.
2. One timeless answer to health is a balanced diet.
3. A recent study in *Proceedings of the Royal Society B* shows that wild bumblebees eat a balanced diet.
4. Eight species of bumblebees were studied in the Colorado Rockies over eight years.
5. Bees do not collect pollen randomly; different pollens carry different macronutrient compositions (protein, fats, carbohydrates).
6. Some pollens are protein-rich (“like a steak”), others lighter in nutrients (“like a salad”).
7. Bees display collective intelligence to ensure balanced nutrition for the colony.
8. Larger-bodied bees consume protein-rich pollen, while short-tongued bees seek carbohydrate- and fat-rich pollen.
9. This shows that bees distribute roles to maintain overall nutritional balance.
10. A similar study on elephants (Royal Society Open Science) revealed they also eat a varied diet shaped by biological and social needs.
11. Unlike animals, humans complicate health with contradictory advice, diets, and fitness trends.
12. The real solution remains simple: balanced diet, rest, and exercise — and when confused, follow the bees.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based

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